# TALA JOUDEH

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## SUMMARY

People Partner with 13+ years across fintech, SaaS, government, and professional services, combining six years of HR consulting at PwC People & Organization Advisory with seven years in-house, twice joining as the first dedicated HRBP and building the People function from the ground up. Track record of designing performance management cycles, manager enablement programmes, and HR frameworks from scratch in high-growth, fast-moving businesses. Trusted advisor to founders, CEOs, and executive committees on people strategy, organisational design, and complex employee relations. Deep UAE labour law expertise, regional experience across the GCC and wider EMEA, and a data-informed approach to diagnosing people risk and shaping People strategy.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic HR Business Partnering | Performance Management & Calibration Cycles | Manager Enablement & Coaching | Building People Frameworks from Scratch | Organisational Design & Job Architecture | Complex Employee Relations & Terminations | Promotion, Growth Planning & Succession | Engagement Surveys & Action Planning | UAE Labour Law & Multi-Country Compliance | Data-Informed People Strategy | HRIS & HR Operations | Scaling People Functions in High-Growth Environments

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**Capital.com | Dubai, UAESeptember 2025 to Present**

*HR Business Partner (MEA) | Fintech Trading Platform*

- Sole HR Partner for the MEA and Emerging Markets business (100+ staff), joining a UAE business with limited HR infrastructure and building the People function from the ground up while acting as trusted advisor to the CEO MEA, the Executive Committee, and the newly appointed UAE GM
- Coach and influence senior leaders and department heads across the region on people strategy, performance management, employee relations, and team design; serve as the go-to advisor for high-trust, sensitive people matters
- Built the UAE Performance Improvement Plan and disciplinary frameworks from scratch where none existed, including workflows, manager toolkits, documentation aligned to UAE labour law, and live application to active cases handled with discretion and professionalism
- Partner with the global People team on the annual performance and compensation cycle for the MEA business, including calibration, promotion roundtables, salary review, compensation banding discussions, and year-end decisions
- Led four redundancy cases end-to-end with zero escalations, designing the UAE redundancy framework from the ground up and partnering with managers and legal counsel on consultation planning, documentation, and execution
- Researched, designed, and launched an updated parental leave policy, strengthening the wellbeing and inclusion agenda and improving manager and employee experience
- Authored the annual Turnover and Headcount Insights report and established a quarterly Board and ExCo cadence covering people insights, risks, and recommended actions, now embedded as standard governance input
- Use AI to convert qualitative employee and manager input into structured insights on turnover and people risk for senior leadership, and to pressure-test analysis before presenting to the GM, Board, and ExCo
- Own the UAE HR Operations function end-to-end, including HRIS (Bayzat), payroll co-ownership with Finance for 100+ employees, visa and work permit processes, mobility, leave administration, and benefits

**Sprinklr | Dubai, UAEJuly 2023 to August 2025**

*Regional HR Business Partner, Strategy & Operations (EMEA) | Enterprise SaaS*

- Joined as the first in-house regional HRBP for the UAE office, building the local People function from scratch and scaling it to support 150+ Middle East employees across Sales, Consulting, Services, Success, and Product through 20% annual headcount growth and simultaneous restructuring cycles

- Served as trusted People advisor to department heads and managers across the UAE, Qatar, and the wider EMEA region on performance management, employee relations, career development, and complex case handling; coached managers through investigations, disciplinary action, grievances, and difficult conversations
- Led 19 restructuring exits across the UAE and Qatar in full compliance with local labour law and with zero non-compliance findings, partnering with managers, Legal, and global HR to deliver sensitive change with empathy and rigour
- Authored the Middle East HR policy framework from scratch, covering leave, performance, employee relations, exit, and mobility, standardising operations across the UAE and Qatar and giving managers a clear playbook for high-frequency situations
- Ran the regional engagement survey execution and follow-up for the Middle East, translating findings into action plans owned at manager and leadership level within a global matrixed structure
- Delivered operational HR support to 300+ employees across the UK, France, Italy, and Spain as primary owner of the regional inbox; reduced response time from one week to 24–48 hours by standardising core processes and manager guidance
- Built and ran the UAE and Qatar government and visa processes, embedding compliant workflows for visa initiations, renewals, and cancellations, and establishing a single source of truth for government-related HR activity

**BOOST | Dubai, UAEApril 2021 to July 2023**

*Head of People Strategy & Organizational Projects*

- Trusted advisor to the CEO and Founder on people and organisation strategy in a high-growth environment, shaping the people roadmap aligned to growth priorities and advising on team design, leadership development, and workforce planning
- Designed and rolled out a recruitment framework that reduced time-to-hire by 40% and lifted offer acceptance to 90%, improving candidate experience and manager involvement during a high-growth period
- Built a project management process and staffing model that improved delivery quality, efficiency, and client value across people-related engagements

**Independent HR Consulting | Dubai, UAENovember 2020 to March 2021**

*Engagement Leader, Heidrick & Struggles | Project Manager, Confidential (Sustainability)*

- Designed an organisational transformation implementation plan for a confidential UAE government entity harmonising multiple bodies; advised the CHRO on talent development and performance management at strategic and operational levels
- Led the organisation design and HR workstream (structure, job architecture, policies, procedures, and processes) for a large-scale sustainability project, managing a global team of subject matter experts

**AstroLabs | Dubai, UAEJanuary 2020 to November 2020**

*People Operations & Programs Manager | MENA Startup Ecosystem*

- Built core HR processes from the ground up across performance, people operations, and the employee lifecycle in a startup-ecosystem environment
- Developed the People Agenda spanning Employer Branding, Organisational Effectiveness, L&D, Performance, Retention, and Engagement, and led process re-engineering and policy refresh

**The Knowledge Fund, Dubai Government | Dubai, UAEFebruary 2019 to January 2020**

*Senior Business Performance Specialist*

- Built the organisational KPI framework with Dubai Government HR, the CEO, and the Board, cascading strategic KPIs to functional and individual level and driving a 60% increase in performance tracking accuracy
- Developed core processes and procedures aligned to UAE legal and HR regulations as part of an enterprise-wide operational improvement programme

**PricewaterhouseCoopers | Dubai, UAEMarch 2013 to February 2019**

*Senior Consultant, People & Organization Advisory | Government, Oil & Gas, Financial Services, Healthcare*

- Advised CHROs and senior business leaders across six years of consulting engagements on organisational design, job architecture, HR strategy, performance management, succession planning, and workforce planning for entities with 1,000+ staff
- Built and re-engineered performance management frameworks, talent and succession planning processes, and employee relations policies across multi-year engagements
- Led change management and manager enablement on three government projects, achieving over 90% stakeholder buy-in and successful post-merger integration through communications, manager training, and organisational effectiveness interventions
- Mentored junior consultants and led delivery teams, building HR capability and consistent service quality across complex multi-stakeholder programmes
- Led PwC MENA engagement initiatives, including a large-scale engagement survey, translating findings into action plans that addressed root-cause improvement opportunities

## EDUCATION, CERTIFICATIONS & LANGUAGES

- **B.Sc. Business Administration** (Concentration: Management), American University of Sharjah, 2013
- **PRINCE2 Certification**
- **Languages:** English (native), Arabic (native)
- **Tools:** Workday, Bayzat, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office, Slack, Jira, Asana; AI-enabled HR workflows